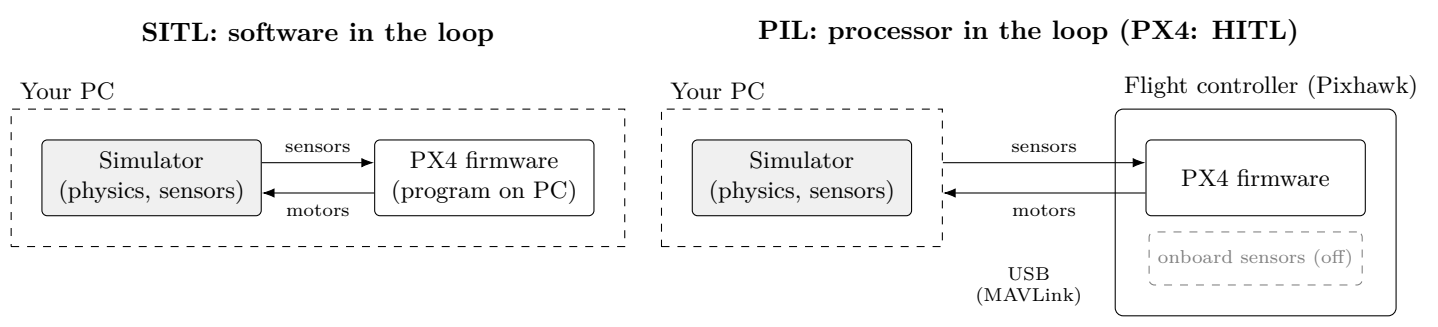

SITL: software in the loop
Your PC
Simulator
(physics, sensors)
sensors
motors
PX4 firmware
(program on PC)
PIL: processor in the loop (PX4: HITL)
Your PC
Simulator
(physics, sensors)
sensors
motors
USB
(MAVLink)
Flight controller (Pixhawk)
PX4 firmware
onboard sensors (off)